

Perhaps my fascination with discussions around nature and nurture is the result of being one of three children who are all so incredibly different—I've had people shake their heads in wonderment that we're all related and grew up in the same household.

But why is that? After all, we each had the same financial modelling growing up—our dad was an accountant and we were taught some money lessons, including budgeting and credit—we would sign ahead for our pocket money and then go without it during those weeks we'd gone into credit for. We grew up in the western suburbs of Sydney, where we were modelled the values of frugality and hard work. Dad retired comfortably in his early fifties but never showed us how he achieved that financially, other than the lesson of working exceptionally hard. Truth be told, even Mum wasn't shown how this happened: she was simply told to sign documents. Thankfully for her, these documents were for the purchase of assets that improved our family's financial position. It was only after Dad retired that he sat Mum down and explained to her that they owned more and were in a better financial position than she'd understood.

In the absence of a financial narrative, it's probably no surprise that my siblings and I each came up with our own. As a result, we each have not only different Money Types but different Money Stories and very different money habits.

But it's not only finances where we differ. Certainly, if you simply compare my younger sister Jodie and I, we've made very different decisions around most life choices—from our education to where we live, whether we have children or not, how we express our spirituality, our vocational choices, our decisions around where we work and how much we work, how we holiday, how we prioritise our spending and so much more. I lovingly describe Jodie as a bohemian hippy, while I'm the other, almost obsessive compulsive extreme. Our life experiences and environments since we were twenty years old have been vastly different but it still surprises me that in so many facets of our lives, including our finances, we're so incredibly different.

Now, I'm not suggesting my sister's life choices are better or worse than mine. I am, however, suggesting that we both approach most parts of our lives, including our finances, in very different ways.